準2級+

第11回

英検準2級プラス形式

リーディング練習

第11回　｜　部分演習（筆記全体の制限時間は流用しません）　｜　選択問題 31問

■ 出題構成・自己採点記録表

大問	問題番号	出題形式・内容	設問数	自己採点・点検
1	(1)〜(17)	短文の語句空所補充	17問	／17
2	(18)〜(23)	長文の語句空所補充	6問	／6
3	(24)〜(31)	長文の内容一致選択	8問	／8

■ 演習・印刷の手引き

1. 問題冊子には正答や解説を載せていません。解答用紙はA4横マークシート（1ページ）です。
2. 印刷時は「白黒・実際のサイズ（100%）」を選ぶと、マーク欄や英作文罫線が本番見本に近い実寸で出力されます。
3. 解き終わるまでは「解答・解説」を開かず、本番と同じ時間配分を意識して取り組んでください。
4. 同じ選択問題はアプリの「分野別練習」、英作文課題はアプリの「ライティング練習」でも学習・保存できます。

実施日：　　年　　月　　日　　開始〜終了：　　：　　〜　　：

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿　　選択問題 合計：　　／31 点

※ 本冊子はマナトビが独自に執筆・編集した英検準2級プラス形式のオリジナル教材（第11回）です。リスニング・二次面接は含みません。日本英語検定協会の公式過去問・公式予想問題ではなく、CSEスコア算出や合否判定は行いません。外部機関による難度校正は未実施です。

1

次の(1)から(17)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

(1) To (　　) confusion at the baggage carousel, tie a brightly colored ribbon to your black suitcase.

1 award　**2** await　**3** avoid　**4** awaken

(2) The botanical conservatory maintains tropical warmth year-round by (　　) of waste heat from a nearby bakery factory.

1 means　**2** terms　**3** ways　**4** sake

(3) After the microphone failed twice, the guest speaker dispensed (　　) amplification and projected her voice naturally.

1 into　**2** of　**3** from　**4** with

(4) Because cedar shingles split cleanly along the grain, skilled roofers can layer them into a (　　) shield against mountain rain.

1 lukewarm　**2** watertight　**3** outspoken　**4** short-sighted

(5) Seldom (　　) coastal ferries cancel sailings in July unless a typhoon approaches the strait.

1 have　**2** are　**3** do　**4** were

(6) Although the pottery studio's roof survived the storm, repairing the flooded kiln room will take months to see (　　).

1 across　**2** over　**3** into　**4** through

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(7) The nutritionist emphasized that vitamin supplements should complement, not act as a (　　) for, balanced daily meals.

1 substitute　**2** statute　**3** symptom　**4** surplus

(8) All volunteers are requested to sign in at the tent upon (　　) at the riverbed cleanup site.

1 arrive　**2** arriving　**3** arrived　**4** to arrive

(9) With train seats sold out for Golden Week, my uncle fell (　　) on driving overnight along the coast.

1 back　**2** down　**3** out　**4** off

(10) The conductor insisted that every brass player (　　) ten minutes early to tune instruments together.

1 arrived　**2** arrives　**3** arrive　**4** arriving

(11) Years of sorting handwritten postcards gave the veteran postal clerk an uncanny (　　) for reading messy addresses.

1 knee　**2** knot　**3** knob　**4** knack

(12) Much (　　) I admire the architect's bold glass roof, I worry it will overheat the reading room in August.

1 though of　**2** as　**3** despite　**4** whereas

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(13) To keep mud off library carpets, patrons are asked to wipe their soles thoroughly on the mat (　　) entering.

1 until　**2** unless　**3** before　**4** during

(14) The fishing cooperative imposed a size limit on clams so young shellfish have time to (　　) at least once.

1 reprimand　**2** reproduce　**3** recollect　**4** reconcile

(15) No sooner had the bakery hung out its "Fresh Apple Pie" sign (　　) a line formed along the sidewalk.

1 than　**2** when　**3** that　**4** as

(16) Because mountain weather shifts without warning, experienced guides always pack extra fleece layers as a (　　).

1 proportion　**2** prediction　**3** profession　**4** precaution

(17) The documentary praised how local high schoolers helped (　　) a fading traditional puppet play in their valley.

1 revolve　**2** revoke　**3** revive　**4** resent

2 A

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(18)から(20)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Why Supermarkets Angle Aisles and End-Cap Displays Carefully

Shoppers pushing a cart down a grocery aisle often feel they are browsing freely, yet the width of lanes and the displays at the ends of shelves—known in retail as "end caps"—are planned with surprising care. Store designers study foot-traffic patterns to balance smooth movement with product discovery.

End-cap shelves facing the main perimeter walkway command huge attention because shoppers slow down to turn their carts into the next aisle. Manufacturers compete fiercely to place seasonal soup, pasta sauce, or tea on those prime corners. Shoppers frequently assume every item stacked high on an end cap is deeply discounted, even when the price tag shows the regular shelf price. (***18***), careful buyers check the unit price per hundred grams before tossing an end-cap item into their cart.

Aisle width shapes behavior just as strongly. Make an aisle too narrow, and whenever two carts pass, nobody dares stop to compare nutrition labels—a phenomenon retail researchers call the "butt-brush effect," where crowded shoppers hurry away without buying. Widening high-margin aisles slightly gives customers comfortable breathing room. (***19***), placing everyday staples like milk and eggs at the far back draws visitors past dozens of other shelves along the way.

Recognizing these quiet layout strategies lets shoppers navigate stores efficiently while (***20***).

(18)　**1** For that reason　**2** On the contrary　**3** Otherwise　**4** Previously

(19)　**1** For example　**2** Consequently　**3** In vain　**4** Meanwhile

(20)

1 refusing to buy milk or eggs ever again

2 sticking to their budget and actual household needs

3 pushing carts sideways to block narrow aisles

4 paying twice the regular price on purpose

2 B

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(21)から(23)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

How Bamboo Scaffolding Still Rises Around High-Rise Towers

Visitors stepping onto the streets of Hong Kong for the first time often look up in disbelief: encasing forty-story glass skyscrapers are intricate lattices of golden bamboo poles lashed together with black nylon strips. In an era of steel cranes and aluminum frames, traditional bamboo scaffolding remains a thriving engineering craft.

Speed, weight, and flexibility explain bamboo's staying power in dense subtropical cities. Thick giant-timber bamboo stalks weigh a fraction as much as steel pipes yet boast remarkable tensile strength along their hollow fibers. Experienced scaffolders carry bundles easily up narrow stairwells and tie custom grids around irregular balconies or curved neon signs without welding or heavy bolts. (***21***), a skilled crew can wrap a mid-rise facade far faster and at lower cost than with rigid metal tubing.

Typhoon winds reveal another surprising advantage. Whereas rigid steel frames can transmit violent gusts into building anchors or snap suddenly, properly braced bamboo flexes slightly with the wind to absorb energy. Safety standards are far from casual, however: Hong Kong building codes specify pole thickness, curing age, steel wall-anchors, and formal apprenticeships. (***22***), many modern projects use a hybrid approach—steel brackets at the base supporting bamboo lattices above.

Combining renewable fast-growing grass with rigorous safety engineering shows that traditional materials can (***23***).

(21)

1 On the other hand　**2** Nevertheless　**3** Accordingly　**4** By accident

(22)

1 In vain　**2** Otherwise　**3** Instead of safety　**4** Moreover

(23)

1 excel in modern cityscapes when backed by clear standards

2 replace glass windows inside forty-story offices

3 stand without any wall anchors during typhoons

4 grow on concrete sidewalks overnight

3 A

次のEメールの内容に関して、(24)から(26)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

From: Stage Manager, High School Drama Club
To: Cast and Backstage Crew
Subject: Wednesday's costume fitting and shoe-sole taping rule

Hi everyone,
Our regional drama festival performance is just ten days away! All cast members must attend costume fitting in Clubroom B this Wednesday between 4:00 p.m. and 5:45 p.m. Because our nineteenth-century coats and dresses are rented from a professional theater wardrobe, alterations must NOT use scissors or permanent glue—we may only baste hems loosely by hand with cotton thread that pulls out cleanly next week.

Please bring the exact socks and indoor stage shoes you will wear on performance day so hem lengths are accurate. Backstage crew members also need to bring their black sneakers on Wednesday: we will apply thin felt strips to everyone's rubber soles so footsteps stay completely silent during dark scene changes.

Break a leg,
Stage Manager

3A　Instructions for Costume Fitting Ahead of Drama Festival　設問 (24)〜(26)

(24) Why are scissors and permanent glue strictly forbidden when adjusting the costumes?

1 The club lost all its scissors last month.

2 The costumes are rented from a professional wardrobe and must be returned undamaged.

3 Cotton thread is ten times stronger than glue.

4 Cast members will buy brand-new jeans instead.

(25) Why must cast members bring the exact socks and stage shoes they will wear on stage?

1 To measure and set hem lengths accurately during fitting.

2 To wash them in Clubroom B's sink.

3 To trade shoes with backstage crew members.

4 Because the theater floor is covered in water.

(26) What will be done to the backstage crew's black sneakers on Wednesday?

1 Metal taps will be nailed onto the heels.

2 Reflective yellow paint will be sprayed on the toes.

3 Thin felt strips will be attached to the soles to silence footsteps during scene changes.

4 The shoelaces will be removed permanently.

3 ***B***

次の英文の内容に関して、(27)から(31)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

How Pumped-Storage Hydropower Acts as a Giant Water Battery

Solar panels and wind turbines now generate affordable clean electricity across much of the world, yet both share a familiar limitation: clouds hide the sun, calm evenings stall wind blades, and peak household demand arrives after sunset when people cook dinner and heat baths. Storing gigawatts of daytime surplus power for evening use has become one of the central engineering challenges of modern grids. Surprisingly, more than ninety percent of large-scale energy storage operating globally today relies not on chemical lithium batteries, but on gravity and water.

Known as "pumped-storage hydropower," the concept uses two water reservoirs sitting at different elevations—typically separated by several hundred meters of vertical mountainside and connected by a steep underground tunnel. At midday, when rooftop solar panels flood the grid with cheap electricity, reversible turbines spin backward as pumps, pushing millions of cubic meters of water from the lower lake up into the mountain reservoir. After dusk, when power demand spikes, operators open the intake gates: stored water rushes back downhill through the same turbines, spinning generators that reach full output within ninety seconds.

Round-trip efficiency reaches roughly seventy-five to eighty percent—meaning three-quarters of the electricity used to pump water uphill comes back onto the grid—and concrete reservoirs last well over half a century without losing capacity the way phone batteries degrade after a thousand charge cycles.

Geography sets strict limits, of course. Flat coastal plains lack the elevation drop needed, and flooding pristine mountain valleys for new reservoirs raises serious ecological concerns. Engineers are therefore exploring closed-loop designs in abandoned deep-pit mines that never touch natural rivers.

Chemical batteries will keep growing rapidly for cars and neighborhood substations, yet wherever mountains meet sunny grids, uphill water remains clean energy's heaviest lifter.

3B　How Pumped-Storage Hydropower Acts as a Giant Water Battery　設問 (27)〜(31)

(27) What accounts for over ninety percent of large-scale grid energy storage operating worldwide today?

1 Flywheels attached to bicycles.

2 Smartphone lithium batteries wired together.

3 Compressed steam inside wooden barrels.

4 Pumped-storage hydropower using water and elevation.

(28) When do operators pump water from the lower lake up to the higher reservoir?

1 Only during peak evening dinner hours.

2 When cheap surplus electricity—such as midday solar power—is abundant on the grid.

3 Only once a year on New Year's Day.

4 Whenever electricity demand exceeds supply.

(29) What durability advantage do concrete pumped-storage reservoirs have over chemical batteries?

1 They work on completely flat plains without hills.

2 They fit easily inside a coat pocket.

3 They operate for over fifty years without losing storage capacity after repeated cycles.

4 They return two hundred percent more energy than they use.

(30) Why are engineers investigating closed-loop systems in abandoned deep-pit mines?

1 To mine gold out of reservoir water.

2 To gain needed elevation differences without damming or harming natural mountain rivers.

3 Because mountain water freezes solid in July.

4 To replace solar panels with underground coal.

(31) How does the author view the future roles of chemical batteries and pumped-storage hydro?

1 Both are valuable: batteries suit vehicles and local substations, while pumped hydro anchors large grids in mountainous regions.

2 Pumped hydro will be dismantled everywhere within five years.

3 Chemical batteries cannot power electric cars.

4 Solar power works without any storage at night.